System for participating in a technical interview:

Never start by writing code! Instead:

1. When reasonable, paraphrase and **repeat the question** back at the interviewer. If you cannot, ask for clarification.
2. When reasonable, **clarify the assumptions**. For example:
    a. How is the input stored?
    b. Are the numbers sorted?
    c. Am I allowed to edit the input?
    d. Can I assume that this is a doubly linked list, rather than singly linked?
3. Come up with **test cases**:
    a. At least one simple test case, with no issues and nothing special happening.
    b. Edge cases.
4. **Come up with approaches**, **discuss them with the interviewer**, and work out how these would run on the test cases.

Only when the interviewer seems happy with your idea, start coding.

While writing the code, say out loud what you are currently working on.

After the code is done, **run the code over the examples "by hand"**. Don't compile yet.